

Video map

Describe the most common video on one sheet. Do not write the script yet; describe the beats and what each must achieve. Short-form platforms reward the same shape: a hook that earns three seconds, a body that earns twenty, and a close that earns the tap.

- 1 Hook (0-3 s): a pattern interrupt, a question or a bold-but-true statement addressed to the target viewer.
- 2 Problem (3-8 s): the pain in the viewer's words, not the brand's.
- 3 Solution (8-18 s): what the product does, shown or named concretely.
- 4 Proof (18-25 s): a demonstrable fact, a number you can back up, a before/after that complies with policy.
- 5 Offer and CTA (25-30 s): one action, one place to do it, one reason to do it now.
- 6 Disclosure: the AI label, sponsorship tag or “dramatised” note the platform or law requires.

One-page creative brief

This brief is the contract between the business and the production pipeline. It does not need to be long, but every field must be filled by someone who knows the product. Show it to the person who answers customer questions – they know the real objections the owner often forgets.

Field	Example
Goal	Leads for a teeth-whitening offer at a dental clinic.
Audience	Women 25-40, city, scrolls Reels in the evening, price-sensitive.
Offer	Free consultation plus 20% off the first session this month.
Approved claims	“Visible result after one session for most patients” – not “guaranteed white teeth”.
Forbidden claims	Medical outcomes, comparisons to named competitors, “no pain”.
Proof available	Number of sessions done, before/after photos with signed release.
Format	9:16, 25-35 s, captions on, sound on, avatar presenter with product B-roll.
Success	Hook rate above 35% and cost per lead below the current creative within 72 h.

Don't start with “it can do everything”

The first system should produce one format reliably: one platform, one length, one presenter. After 20-30 published variants you will know which second format actually brings value.

4. Platforms, formats and the first three seconds

The same clip is not “fine everywhere”. Each platform has its own frame, safe zone and rhythm.

```
05_exports/      2026-09_whitening_hookB_v2_9x16.mp4
99_report/       2026-09_report.pdf
```

```
name = {campaign}_{hook}_{version}_{stage}.{ext}
```

Step by step for one campaign

- 1 Fill the one-page brief and the approved-claims list; get written sign-off.
- 2 Run the scripting prompt; pick 3-5 hooks and one body; get sign-off on claims and disclosure.
- 3 Prepare the TTS text: numbers in words, pronunciation dictionary for the brand, tags or breaks.
- 4 Generate audio for each hook plus the shared body; listen to every file end to end.
- 5 Render avatar clips in HeyGen from the approved audio; inspect at 100% zoom on a phone.
- 6 Finish in Captions with the client's locked template; export named variants.
- 7 Run the QA checklist (chapter 13) and the disclosure checklist (chapter 12).
- 8 Publish 3-5 variants; measure for 48-72 hours; keep, iterate or kill.

Checkpoints between tools

Hand-off	Check before moving on
Brief → Script	Every claim in the script appears in the approved list; length within the time budget.
Script → Audio	Names, numbers, dates read correctly; no audible tags; pace 2.3-2.7 words/s; file named with version.
Audio → Avatar	Same audio version as approved; lip-sync tight at the start and end; hands and background clean.
Avatar → Edit	Captions match the audio word for word; safe zone respected; CTA card matches the offer; music licensed for the platform.
Edit → Publish	Correct ratio and resolution; AI label set where required; ad-account naming matches the file name.

Do not re-generate upstream after downstream work is done unless you re-run everything below it. A changed word in the audio means a new avatar render and a new edit; that is cheap in credits but expensive in confusion if the versions are not tracked.

10. Variations, testing and what to measure

The pipeline's real value is not one video – it is ten comparable videos and a decision.

Creative testing is where the AI chain pays for itself. A human shoot gives you one or two versions; the pipeline gives you a matrix. But a matrix only works if you change one variable at a time and read the right numbers. The platforms agree on the basics: test 3-5 creatives per ad group, judge after a short window and refresh when delivery declines.

A checklist does not replace judgement, but it protects against omissions in a repeatable process. Turn it into a task in your project tool and require a name and date next to every critical check. The answer “it looked fine on my laptop” is not a test.

Demo readiness

- The brief exists and the demo script uses only approved claims.
- A stock or photo avatar is used – no real likeness without consent.
- Voice generated on a paid ElevenLabs plan; brand name pronounced correctly.
- Captions inside the safe zone; the hook works muted.
- The AI presenter label is visible.
- Three hook variants demonstrate the testing idea.

Pilot readiness

- Signed releases and consent videos on file for every real presenter.
- Claims list, forbidden list and disclosure text approved by the client's owner.
- Locked finishing template and naming convention.
- QA checklist passed on real phones for every variant.
- Platform AI labels set; music licensed for the placement.
- Ad-account access or a reporting export agreed; owner of the daily check named.

Production readiness

- Credits, plan limits and budget alerts monitored across all four tools.
- A fallback presenter or tool in case a twin is rejected or a service is down.
- Rights renewals and takedown procedure calendared.
- Prompt, template and settings versions traceable to published variants.
- The client knows what the system can and cannot do.
- A periodic report and an improvement loop are in place.